

FOUNDING ENGINEER

The Council of Ministers

Madrid, Moncloa — the problem nobody can see.

THE PROBLEM

Every Tuesday the **Council of Ministers** meets. This year they made the country a promise: a simpler, cleaner statute book — *fewer laws, clearer ones*. A real legislative-simplification mandate, announced, with political capital on the line.

There is one problem. Nobody can actually see the statute book.

Spanish law is a corpus of consolidated norms published across two centuries, each one amending and citing the others in a tangle no human has ever held in their head. When a minister asks “which laws should we simplify first?”, the honest answer today is a shrug and a binder. The Council governs the regulatory state half-blind.

Your job: turn the Boletín Oficial del Estado into a knowledge graph, and make it answer the four questions the Council of Ministers will actually ask in that room.

YOUR CORPUS

Ingest the **complete BOE consolidated-legislation corpus** through the public API (boe.es/datosabiertos). The catalogue is large, but the API is paginated and uniform.

A MINIMAL GUIDE

- The `analysis` block of each norm exposes the relationships you need — *amends, amended by, repeals, repealed by, cites*. It is the raw material for the four briefings.
- The in-force status (`estatus_derogacion`) tells you whether a norm is live or repealed. Read it carefully: there are nuances (total repeal, partial repeal, in force with amendments).
- Stack is your choice — database, framework and visualization library are yours to pick. What we value is judgment: what you prioritise, what you decide not to build, and why.

THE FOUR BRIEFINGS THE COUNCIL NEEDS

01 Diagnosis: which laws have become unreadable?

The Vice-Presidency wants the consolidation backlog: the laws amended so many times they are now incomprehensible even to lawyers. Give the **top 5**. These are the first candidates for a clean rewrite.

(The 5 norms most amended by other norms.)

02 Root cause: who made the mess?

Show the Council *how* laws become unreadable. Find the “omnibus” laws — single acts that silently rewrote dozens of unrelated statutes at once. Name the **top 5 worst offenders**. The Council wants to see the pattern, not just the symptom.

(The 5 norms that amend the most other norms.)

03

The rot: how much of the statute book rests on dead law?

Find every law still in force that cites a law already repealed. Quantify it: what fraction of live Spanish law rests on legal ground that no longer exists? Then surface the **top 5 most-cited ghosts** — the dead laws still propping up the most live statutes.

(The percentage of in-force norms that cite at least one repealed norm, and the 5 repealed norms most cited by in-force norms.)

04

The scalpel: the unfinished repeal.

In 2015 the Council repealed **Ley 30/1992, the act on the Legal Regime of Public Administrations and Common Administrative Procedure**, and replaced it with Leyes 39/2015 and 40/2015. But the cleanup was never finished: dozens of laws still in force keep citing Ley 30/1992 as if it existed. The Council wants to close the operation — update those orphan references — and needs the worklist. Compute the **blast radius** of Ley 30/1992: the laws still in force that cite it **directly**.

(The list of in-force norms that cite Ley 30/1992 directly.)

DELIVERABLES · ONE WEEK

- 1 **Code** in a public repository. We expect Claude Code or similar in the loop.
- 2 **A web platform** with the **interactive graph** — navigable, with zoom, filters and search — and the **results of the four briefings** integrated into it. A minister should be able to open it and understand each answer without reading a single query.
- 3 **A 1-page design doc**: your schema, and why.
- 4 **A 5-minute video** showing the results and the platform. Remember: it is addressed to the Council of Ministers.

BONUS — IF YOU HAVE TIME LEFT Surprise us. Something we didn't ask for but that proves the problem, the tool, or your judgment.

Make the Council see its own statute book for the first time.